

Nicolas's Football Playbook

A picture guide to the field, the throws, the catches, the rules, and the joy of the game.

Welcome, Nicolas. You already know how to throw a ball. You've been chucking things at trees since you could walk. Now we're going to learn the whole game — every line on the field, the names of every move, how to score. Take your time. Look at the pictures. Watch a video. Try a drill. Football is not about being perfect. It's about getting curious, working the process, and finding joy in the catch. And the best part — football is a game you can love forever, whether you play it or watch the Patriots on Sundays.

What's inside this playbook



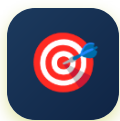
The Field

A picture map of a football field — end zones, yard lines, hash marks, goal posts. Every part labeled.



Rules & Safety

10 flag football rules. Snap. 4 downs. Flag-pull instead of tackle. Honors. The basics of the game.



Skills & Moves

Throwing a spiral. Catching with two hands. Running routes. Flag pulling. The snap. The moves every player knows.



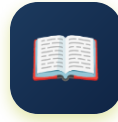
Lesson Plans

Four lesson formats. From backyard catch to a real 5-on-5 flag football game.



Fun Games

Brother games. 500. Two-hand touch. Hot potato football. Things to play any time.



Your Football Story

A picture story about a football practice day — what to expect, what to do, what to feel.

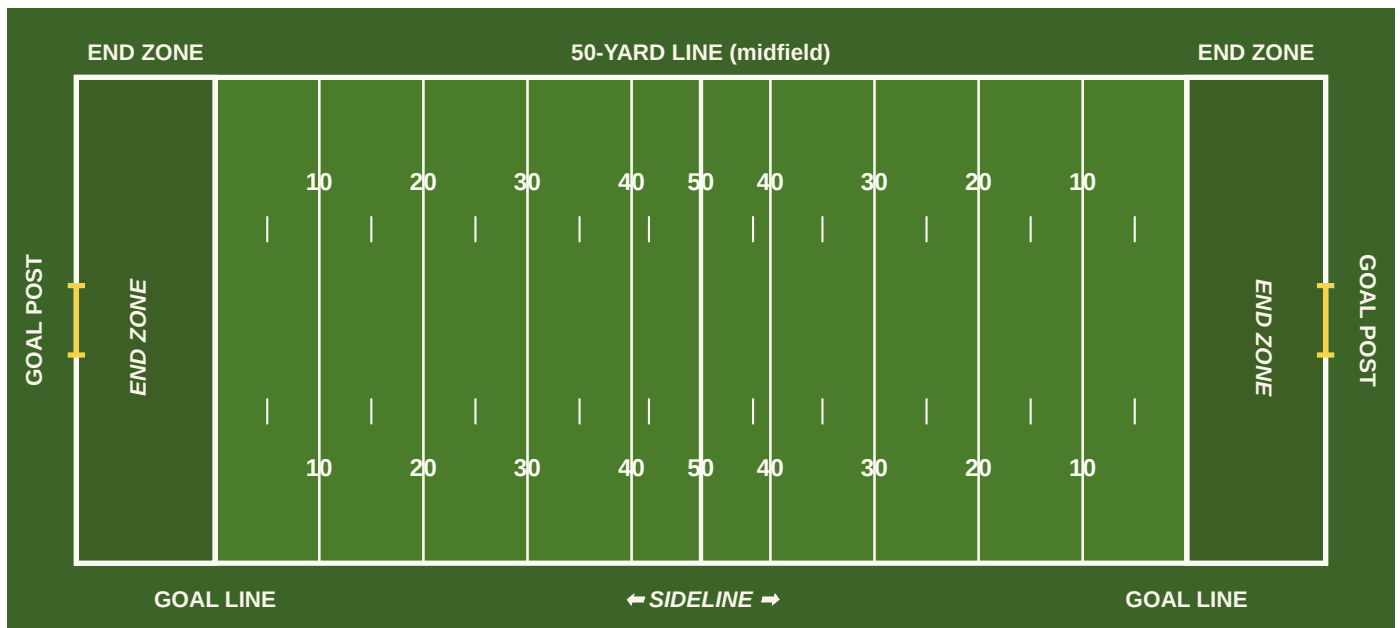


Football Songs

Custom Suno songs made just for you.
Listen before practice to get ready, or after a great game to celebrate.

'' The best player is not the one with the most touchdowns. The best player is the one who keeps showing up, keeps trying, and remembers to smile after a great catch. ''

Every line on the football field has a name and a job. The field is a giant map of yards — every 5 yards a stripe, every 10 yards a number. Once you know the map, the game makes sense.



The lines and what they mean

End zone

The painted area at each end of the field, 10 yards deep. Get the ball into the OTHER team's end zone = TOUCHDOWN!

💬 "Where touchdowns happen."

Goal line

The line at the front of each end zone. Cross it WITH the ball = touchdown.

💬 "Cross this line with the ball."

Goal post

The yellow "Y" at the back of each end zone. Kick the ball through the uprights = field goal (3 pts) or extra point (1 pt).

💬 "Kick through the Y."

50-yard line (midfield)

The line in the middle of the field. Where most kickoffs happen.

💬 "Middle of the field."

Yard lines

The white lines every 5 yards. Big numbers every 10 yards tell you how far from the nearest end zone.

💬 "Counts the yards left."

Sideline

The long lines on each side. Step on or over it WITH the ball = OUT.

💬 "Step on it = out."

Hash marks

The little ticks inside the field.
Where the ball is placed when
it's spotted between plays.

💬 "Ball goes between these."

Line of scrimmage

An imaginary line at the spot of
the ball each play. NO crossing it
before the snap or it's a penalty.

💬 "Don't cross till the snap."

Football grows with you

Football has stages. Start with flag football (no tackling), build skills, then maybe move to full pads. There is no rush. Every great player started where you are.



Catch Stage

What you learn here: how to hold the ball, how to throw a spiral, how to catch with two hands. Basics for the backyard. This is where every move becomes *yours*.

💬 "Two hands. Look it in."



Flag Stage

What you learn here: flag football. 5-on-5 or 7-on-7. Pull flags instead of tackling. Real positions: quarterback, receiver, defender, rusher.

💬 "Pull the flag."



Game Stage

What you learn here: running plays, route running, reading the defense. Real downs (you get 4 tries to go 10 yards). The game gets fast — so now your *brain* starts playing too.

💬 "Now I think and play."



Player Stage

What you learn here: the full game. Real positions. Real strategy. Maybe full pads when you're older. By now your skills, your rules, and your spirit are all yours.

💬 "My game. Forever."

Watch & learn



Flag Football for Beginners

An intro to flag football rules and gameplay for kids.

▶ Watch



How to Throw a Football

The basics of grip, throwing motion, and spiral for kids.

▶ Watch

Football has clear rules. Once you know them, every game makes sense. We'll focus on flag football here — that's the right form for now.



1. The object of the game

Move the ball into the OTHER team's end zone = TOUCHDOWN (6 points). Most points wins. That's it.

💬 "Ball in their end zone."

▶ Watch



2. Four downs to move 10 yards

Your team gets 4 "downs" (tries) to move the ball 10 yards forward. If you make it = fresh set of 4 downs. If you don't = other team gets the ball.

💬 "4 tries. 10 yards."

▶ Watch



3. Flags instead of tackles

In flag football, you wear a belt with two flags. To "tackle" someone, you pull off one of their flags. No grabbing jerseys, no shoving, no tackling.

💬 "Pull the flag. Don't tackle."

▶ Watch



4. Snap starts every play

The center starts the play by snapping the ball backward through their legs to the quarterback. Until the snap, no one can cross the line of scrimmage.

💬 "No moving till the snap."

▶ Watch



5. Pass or run

After the snap, the quarterback can: **PASS** the ball to a receiver, **HAND IT OFF** to a runner, or **RUN** with it. Pick the right play.

💬 "Pass, hand off, or run."

▶ Watch



6. Catching the pass

A pass is caught if **BOTH** feet are in bounds and you have the ball with control. Drop it, or step out = **INCOMPLETE**.

💬 "Two feet. Two hands."

▶ Watch



7. Sideline = out

Step on or over the sideline **WITH** the ball = the play is over. Ball comes back to where you stepped out.

💬 "Step out = play over."

▶ Watch



8. How scoring works

Touchdown (ball in end zone) = **6 points**.
Extra point (run/pass it in from 5 yards) = **1 point**. (Field goals exist too, but most flag leagues skip them.)

💬 "6 + 1 = 7."

▶ Watch



9. Penalties (no's)

No tackling. No blocking with hands. No flag-guarding (covering your flags with your arms). No crossing the line before the snap. Penalty = the team that fouled loses yards.

💬 "Play clean."

▶ Watch



10. Be a great teammate

Pass to the open person. Cheer for your teammates. Listen to the coach. Shake hands after the game — win or lose. Football is a team sport, even in the backyard.

💬 "Help. Cheer. Shake hands."

▶ Watch

▶ Watch

'' Eleven on a side. Or seven on seven. Or two on two. Or just you and Daddy in the backyard. Football is anywhere there's a ball and a target. ''

Watch & learn the rules

Short videos that explain how the game is played. Watch a couple before your first session.



Flag Football Rules

▶ Watch



Beginner Flag Football

▶ Watch



Flag Football Drills

▶ Watch



Flag Football Basics

▶ Watch

Every move in football has a name, a stance, and a path. You already know how to throw. Now let's name the moves and learn the secrets.

The 6 essential moves



Throwing (Spiral)

Grip the ball with fingers across the laces. Step toward your target. Rotate your hips and shoulders. Release as your arm comes over the top. Snap the wrist — that's what makes the SPIRAL.

💬 "Laces. Step. Snap."

▶ Watch



Catching

Two hands. Pinky fingers together for LOW passes (under your chest). Thumbs together for HIGH passes (above your chest). Look the ball INTO your hands. Then pull it tight.

💬 "Look it in. Tuck it."

▶ Watch

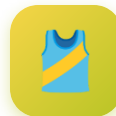


Running with the ball

Hold the ball TIGHT against your body with your strong arm. Cover both ends (one end in your hand, one in your armpit). Keep your other arm free for balance. Run hard.

💬 "Tuck it tight. Run hard."

▶ Watch



Pulling the flag

Get to the ball-carrier's hip area. Grab the FLAG (not the body). Pull straight away. Hold it up so the ref can see.

💬 "Flag, not body."

▶ Watch



Running routes

A "route" is the path a receiver runs after the snap. **Slant:** 3 steps forward, then cut at 45°. **Out:** straight then cut sideways. **Post:** straight then cut toward the goalpost. Plan it before the snap.

 "Run the route I planned."

 Watch



The snap (center exchange)

The center holds the ball, bends over, and PUSHES it backward through their legs to the quarterback. Quarterback catches it and starts the play.

 "Center to QB."

 Watch

 Watch

The Football Grip (for throwing)

Here's how to hold the ball when you throw:

- Spread your fingers ACROSS the laces (the white stripes).
- Index finger near the top, pinky near the bottom.
- Thumb wraps UNDER the ball.
- SMALL space between your palm and the ball (don't crush it).

 "Fingers on laces. Thumb under."

The Receiver's Stance

Before every play, get ready:

- Feet shoulder-width apart, one foot slightly back.
- Knees bent, weight on the balls of your feet.
- Hands ready at your chest, eyes UP looking at the QB.
- Wait for the snap. THEN run your route.

💬 "Ready. Watch. Go on the snap."

The Five Steps of Every Catch



See it

As soon as the ball leaves the QB's hand, find it in the air. Watch only the ball.

💬 "Find it."

▶ Watch



Move

Get your body in line with where the ball will land. Small fast steps.

💬 "Get under it."

▶ Watch



Hands

Two hands. Pinkies together for low passes; thumbs together for high passes.

💬 "Make the diamond."

▶ Watch



Catch

Look the ball INTO your hands. Soft hands — give a little as it arrives.

💬 "Look it in."

▶ Watch



Tuck & run

Pull the ball tight to your body, cover both ends, then RUN.

 "Tuck. Then go."

 Watch

 Watch

The Positions (5-on-5 flag football)

Flag football is simpler than tackle football, but the basic positions still apply. Most kids try every position at first.



Quarterback (QB)

The thrower. Starts every play. Calls "set, hike!" Takes the snap, then either throws or runs (if rules allow).

 "I make the play happen."

 Watch QB basics



Center (C)

Snaps the ball to the QB. Hikes it BETWEEN your legs (or hands it back). Important: once you snap, you can also run a route.

 "Set. Hike. Then go."

 Watch the snap

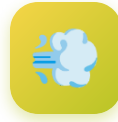


Wide Receiver (WR)

The catcher. Lines up on the sideline before the snap. Runs a route. Catches the ball when the QB throws it.

💬 "Run my route. Look for the ball."

▶ Watch routes



Running Back (RB)

The runner. Lines up next to the QB. Takes a handoff or pitch. Runs with the ball. (Less common in flag football.)

💬 "Take the ball. Find a hole."

▶ Watch running back



Rusher

The defensive player who tries to reach the QB. Must start 7+ yards away on the snap. Goal: pull the QB's flag before they throw.

💬 "Count 1-2-3-4-5, then rush."

▶ Watch the rush



Defender / DB

The receiver-stopper. Stays with a WR or watches for the run. Pulls flags. The hardest position to play well.

💬 "Stay with my person."

▶ Watch coverage

Common Routes (the patterns receivers run)

A "route" is the path the receiver runs after the snap. Each route has a name. Knowing them helps everyone on the team line up.



Slant

Run 3 steps forward. Then cut at a 45° angle TOWARD the middle of the field. Quick, easy catch. The bread-and-butter route.

▶ Watch the slant



Out

Run 5 steps forward. Then cut 90° toward the SIDELINE. Get out of bounds quick if needed.

▶ Watch the out



Post

Run straight up the field. Around 8-10 steps, cut DIAGONALLY toward the goalpost. Deep, dramatic — the big-play route.

▶ Watch the post



Fade / Go

Just RUN. Straight up the sideline. Fast as you can. Don't look back until 3 seconds. The home-run ball.

▶ Watch the fade



Curl / Hook

Run 5-7 steps forward. Then STOP and turn around to face the QB. Catches are easier when you're facing the ball.

▶ Watch the curl



Comeback

Run 10 steps forward FAST. Plant your foot, turn around, run back 2 steps toward QB. Beats defenders who think you're going deep.

▶ Watch the comeback

The structure stays the same so Nicolas can predict what's coming. The content inside the structure changes so it never gets boring. Four lesson formats roll in over the year — one at a time, never all at once. Each format scales to a 60-min lesson with Coach or a 30-min practice with Daddy.

Why formats, not single-skill weeks

Nicolas needs predictable structure. He also needs novelty — but novelty inside the structure, not novelty AS the structure. So instead of "this week we do uppies, next week we do dribbles," every practice follows the same shape: warm up → play → new skill → play with skill → drill → clean up. The shape is the constant. What goes inside each block is what evolves.

Built-in transitions (water cooler, ball machine adjustments, lights on/off) are **part of the practice**, not interruptions. They reset attention between blocks. Plan for them.

The Four Formats

One format starts. A second is added at week 7. A third at week 27. A fourth at week 40. After each addition, formats *rotate* — never converge.

FORMAT A · DISCOVERY

"Look at this. Let's try."

Weeks 1–6 (only format used) · Then in rotation through week 52

Foundation building. Lots of preview, lots of demo, lots of "let's see what this is." Skills are introduced gently and revisited often. Every concept Nicolas needs (court parts, grip, bounce-catch, balance, dribbles, uppies, ready position, drop-and-hit) lives inside this format — woven into the warm-up and the new-skill block instead of taking over the whole session.

With Coach **60 min**

8 min **Warm Up**

Body wake-up + 2 moves from the warm-up menu (e.g., bounce-catch + dribbles).

💬 "Wake up the body."

8 min **Play**

Free play with ball/ball. No goal. No rules. Just fun.

💬 "Just play."

10 min **New Skill Preview**

Watched the video at home? Looked at the picture? Now we name it, demo it, try it slowly.

💬 "Watch. Then try."

10 min **Play with the New Skill**

Put it into a game right away. Low-pressure application.

💬 "Now use it."

10 min **Drill**

Focused repetition. Coach feeds. Nicolas hits.

💬 "Reps build it."

8 min **Favorite Game**

End on a high. Nicolas picks from the games list.

💬 "End on a high."

With Daddy **30 min**

5 min **Warm Up**

1 move from the menu.

💬 "Wake up the body."

6 min **Play**

Free play. Ball machine welcome.

💬 "Just play."

7 min **Skill**

Revisit or preview. Quick.

💬 "Watch. Then try."

7 min **Play with Skill**

Apply it in a game.

💬 "Now use it."

5 min **Clean Up**

Lights, water, gear. Same exit ritual.

💬 "Pack up. Water. Thank you."

5 min

Clean Up

Pick up balls, water, exit ritual (handshake, "thank you").

💬 *"Pack up. Water. Thank you."*

FORMAT B · RALLY

"Back and forth. Keep it going."

Introduced Week 7 · Alternates with A through week 26

Once foundations land, the focus shifts to *game skills*. Less new instruction, more applying what you know. Routes, throws, catches, hand-offs. Nicolas gets to feel like a real football player — touching the ball, moving with purpose, the rhythm of the game.

With Coach **60 min**

8 min

Warm Up

2 menu moves (faster reps now). Add shadow swings.

☞ "Wake up the body."

7 min

Rally Ready

Mini bounce-and-hit rally to find the rhythm. No counting yet.

☞ "Find the rhythm."

10 min

Target Challenge

Hoops, cones, or chalk zones on the other side. Hit the target = point.

☞ "Aim and hit."

10 min

Cooperative Rally

Try to beat the team record. "Last week we got to 8. Today let's try 10."

☞ "Beat the record."

10 min

Mini-Game

First to 5 points (or 7). Just for fun, not yet the full scoring system.

☞ "First to five."

10 min

Cool Down Play

Silly low-stakes (Wall Ball, Sharks & Minnows, Steal the Bacon).

☞ "Silly games."

5 min

Clean Up

With Daddy **30 min**

5 min

Warm Up

1–2 menu moves.

☞ "Wake up the body."

10 min

Target Practice

2 cones or 1 hoop. Aim and hit.

☞ "Aim and hit."

10 min

Rally Challenge

Beat the daily record together.

☞ "Beat the record."

5 min

Clean Up

Lights, water, gear.

☞ "Pack up. Water. Thank you."

Same exit ritual as Format A.

💬 *"Pack up. Water. Thank you."*

FORMAT C · MATCH

"Real football. Real game."

Introduced Week 27 · Rotates with A and B through week 39

Now real games enter the picture. The session feels more like a real match without losing the playful frame. Nicolas practices small-sided scrimmages, position play, and managing the regulation challenge of competition. Built-in "champion moments" guarantee a high note at the end.

With Coach **60 min**

8 min

Warm Up

Menu moves + add a few shadow serves and split steps.

☞ "Wake up the body."

5 min

Shadow Preview

No ball. Walk through "today we're playing first-to-7." Practice calling the score out loud.

☞ "Walk it. No ball."

12 min

Point Practice

Single points, no full games. Coach feeds first ball. Play it out.

☞ "One point at a time."

15 min

Mini Match

First to 4 or 7 points, with score-calling. Take a water break between games.

☞ "Real score."

10 min

Champion Moment

A favorite drill or game from earlier. Always end on a win-feeling.

☞ "End on a win."

5 min

Cool Down

Two laps, light stretches, water.

☞ "Lap. Stretch. Water."

5 min

Clean Up

With Daddy **30 min**

5 min

Warm Up

1–2 menu moves.

☞ "Wake up the body."

10 min

Point Practice

Single points. Call the score together.

☞ "One point at a time."

10 min

Mini Game

First to 5. Fast, fun.

☞ "Real score."

5 min

Clean Up

Lights, water, gear.

☞ "Pack up. Water. Thank you."

Same exit ritual.

💬 *"Pack up. Water. Thank you."*

"I am a football player. This is my game."

Introduced Week 40 · Rotates with A, B, and C through week 52

Ownership and reflection. Nicolas chooses his warm-up moves from the menu. He picks one stroke he wants to refine. He plays a tactical game (hit deep, come to net, etc.). And at the end, he watches a short clip or names one win and one challenge — the metacognitive frame that real athletes build.

With Coach **60 min**

8 min

Warm Up — Your Choice

Nicolas picks 2 moves from the menu. He calls them out.

💬 "I pick today."

12 min

Technical Tune-Up

"What do you want to work on today?"
Forehand? Serve? Volley? He chooses.

💬 "Make my best better."

12 min

Tactical Challenge

A game with one specific tactic — "every shot has to land deep" or "sneak to the net."

💬 "One rule. One game."

15 min

Match Play

Full small-sided scrimmage. Real positions, real football.

💬 "Play it real."

8 min

Reflect

Watch a 30-second clip Coach filmed.
Name one win. Name one challenge for next time.

💬 "What did I learn?"

5 min

Clean Up

Same exit ritual.

💬 "Pack up. Water. Thank you."

With Daddy **30 min**

5 min

Warm Up — Choice

Nicolas picks his moves.

💬 "I pick today."

10 min

Tune-Up

One stroke he wants to work on.

💬 "Make my best better."

10 min

Match Play

Quick game, real scoring.

💬 "Play it real."

5 min

Reflect + Clean Up

"What was your favorite shot today?"

💬 "What did I learn?"

The Warm-Up Menu

These are the foundation moves from the original "weeks 1–6." They never go away. They live in the warm-up of every format, every session — picking 1–3 each time, rotating through. New foundation moves get added; old ones fade and return.

Field Walk

Walk every line. Name each one out loud. Stand on the 50, the goal line, the end zone.

 "Name every line."

Body Wake-Up

Jumping jacks, butt kicks, side shuffle, arm circles, high knees. 30 seconds each.

 "Wake the body."

Ball Holds

Hold the ball with the proper grip. Fingers on laces. Switch hands. Build the "feel."

 "Fingers on laces."

Soft Hands

Daddy gently tosses the ball at your chest. Catch with two hands, pinkies together for low, thumbs together for high. 10 in a row.

 "Look it in."

Short Throws

5 yards apart. Throw spirals back and forth. Build distance only when the spiral is tight.

 "Tight spirals first."

Route Walks

Walk through a route at slow speed. Slant. Out. Post. Get the cuts right before you sprint.

 "Sharp cuts."

Flag Pull Drill

Daddy walks/jogs past you holding a flag. Pull it as he passes. Switch sides.

 "Flag, not body."

Center Snaps

Practice snapping the ball between your legs to a partner behind you. Smooth and accurate.

 "Snap straight back."

Stop & Go

Sprint forward. On Daddy's whistle, STOP fast. On the next whistle, GO. Builds route control.

 "Stop on the whistle."

Backpedal

Run BACKWARDS for 5 yards. Defenders need this to stay in front of receivers. Small fast steps, eyes UP.

 "Eyes up. Small steps."

The 52-Week Rotation

Each week shows the format used and the new content focus inside it. Skills can rotate, fade, return, or be skipped. Life happens — there is no falling behind.

Phase 1 · Discover the Ball

Weeks 1–6

Format A only

Same shape every time

Six weeks of the exact same lesson shape. Every block in the same order. The content inside the warm-up and the new-skill block rotates through the foundation moves so Nicolas gets familiar with all of them — but the structure never moves. This is when the format becomes *predictable*. After six weeks, he knows it.

WEEK 1 **A**

Discover the Field

Warm-up: body wake-up + field walk. *New skill:* name every line (yard lines, end zones, goal posts). *Play:* tag in the end zone.

WEEK 2 **A**

Discover the Ball

Warm-up: ball holds + body wake-up. *New skill:* proper grip (fingers on laces). *Play:* hand-off relay.

WEEK 3 **A**

Discover the Catch

Warm-up: ball holds + soft hands. *New skill:* two-hand catch — thumbs together for high, pinkies together for low. *Play:* 10 chest catches in a row.

WEEK 4 **A**

Discover the Throw

Warm-up: soft hands + short throws. *New skill:* the throwing motion — step, rotate, release with wrist snap. *Play:* 5-yard catch with Daddy.

WEEK 5 **A**

Discover the Spiral

Warm-up: short throws. *New skill:* wrist snap that makes the ball SPIN. Tight spirals fly straighter.

WEEK 6 **A**

Discover Running with the Ball

Warm-up: ball holds. *New skill:* tuck the ball tight, cover both ends, run with purpose.

Phase 2 · Adding Game Skills

Weeks 7–26

A & B alternating

First format change

Format B joins. The two formats alternate every other week — A, then B, then A, then B. Format A keeps introducing new technical pieces (routes, throws, catches); Format B applies them in cooperative drills. Watch for Nicolas noticing the new format. Talk about it. Use the visual schedule to preview the difference.

WEEK 7 **A**

Spiral Refined

New skill: smooth release. Step toward target. Snap the wrist. Tight spirals only.

WEEK 9 **A**

Slant Route

New skill: 3 steps forward, then cut at 45° toward the middle. Sharp cut.

WEEK 11 **A**

Out Route

New skill: straight forward, then cut sideways toward the sideline. Stop your feet HARD on the cut.

WEEK 13 **A**

Post Route

New skill: straight forward, then cut toward the goal post (45° toward middle, deeper than slant).

WEEK 15 **A**

Flag Pull Drill

New skill: Daddy jogs past wearing a flag belt. Pull the flag straight away. Hold it up.

WEEK 17 **A**

Center Snap

New skill: hold ball with one hand. Bend over. Snap ball BACKWARDS through your legs to Daddy (the QB).

WEEK 8 **B**

Catch Rally

How many catches in a row with Daddy? Beat the record.

WEEK 10 **B**

Slant & Catch

Run the slant. Daddy throws. Catch and tuck. 10 reps.

WEEK 12 **B**

Out & Catch

Run the out. Daddy throws. Catch in stride.

WEEK 14 **B**

Route Mix

Daddy calls "slant!", "out!", or "post!" — you run the route called. Catch the pass.

WEEK 16 **B**

Flag Chase

Daddy is the runner. Nicolas chases and pulls the flag. Then switch.

WEEK 18 **B**

Snap & Throw

You snap to Daddy. He throws. You run a route. Catch. Tuck.

WEEK 19 **A****Hand-Off**

New skill: take a hand-off from the QB. Arms create a "pocket" (one up, one down). QB places the ball, you clamp it.

WEEK 21 **A****Backpedal & Plant**

New skill: defensive footwork. Run backwards, then plant your foot and break in any direction.

WEEK 23 **A****QB Mechanics**

New skill: 3-step drop after the snap. Plant, scan the field, throw to the open receiver.

WEEK 25 **A****Defending the Pass**

New skill: knock the ball down (don't catch — just smack it away if you can't intercept).

WEEK 20 **B****Hand-Off & Run**

Daddy hands off. Nicolas runs through cones to the end zone.

WEEK 22 **B****Mirror Drill**

Daddy is the receiver. Nicolas backpedals, mirrors Daddy's moves. Stay in front.

WEEK 24 **B****3-Step Drop & Throw**

Snap. Drop. Throw. Repeat to multiple targets.

WEEK 26 **B****Backyard Showdown**

End-of-phase celebration. 1-on-1 throw-and-catch contest. Best of 10.

Phase 3 · Adding Match Play**Weeks 27–39****A, B & C rotating****Real scoring arrives**

Format C enters. Now three formats rotate (A → B → C → A → B → C...). Format C is where real small-sided games happen. Format A keeps introducing new skills (reading defenses, stiff-arms, play calling). Format B keeps the cooperative drill muscle. Format C is where Nicolas practices the regulation challenge of competitive games with built-in safety: champion moments, water breaks, predictable structure.

WEEK 27 **C**

First 1-on-1 Drive

Format C debuts. Nicolas as QB+receiver vs Daddy as defender. 4 downs to score.

WEEK 29 **B**

Pre-Snap Read

Daddy moves around as a defender. Nicolas calls out where the open space is.

WEEK 31 **A**

Stiff-Arm

New skill: while running with the ball, push a defender away with your open palm (in flag football, gentle push only — no contact in the face).

WEEK 33 **C**

3-on-3 Match

Bigger scrimmage. Real positions: QB, two receivers, two defenders.

WEEK 35 **B**

Run the Play

Huddle. Break. Snap. Run the play exactly as called.

WEEK 37 **A**

QB Scrambling

New skill: if the pocket breaks down, RUN. Pick up yards with your legs.

WEEK 28 **A**

Reading the Defense

New skill: before the snap, LOOK at the defense. Where are they? Open spots = throw there.

WEEK 30 **C**

2-on-2 Backyard Game

Need at least 4 players (Daddy + sibling + neighbor?). Real teams. Real flags. Real plays.

WEEK 32 **B**

Run & Defend

Nicolas runs with the ball. Daddy tries to pull the flag. Practice the stiff-arm.

WEEK 34 **A**

Play Calling

New skill: huddle up before each play. Pick the play. Everyone knows their job.

WEEK 36 **C**

Match with Downs

Real downs: 4 tries to go 10 yards. First down resets the count.

WEEK 38 **B**

Scramble Game

Daddy rushes the passer. Nicolas scrambles, picks up yards on the ground.

WEEK 39 **C**

Backyard Bowl

Best of 3 games. Champion moment ending.

Trophy treat.

Phase 4 • Becoming a Football Player

Weeks 40–52

A, B, C & D rotating

Ownership emerges

Format D enters. All four rotate (A → B → C → D → A → B → C → D...). Format D is where Nicolas becomes the author. He picks his warm-up. He picks the skill to refine. He reflects at the end. The other formats keep doing what they do — but now there's a session every fourth week where he's running the show.

WEEK 40 **D**

I Choose My Warm-Up

Format D debuts. Nicolas picks 2 menu moves.

Picks one skill to refine.

WEEK 41 **A**

Reading on the Run

New skill: while running a route, look back EARLY to find the ball.

WEEK 42 **B**

Look-Back Catch

Run the route. Look back at exactly the right moment. Catch.

WEEK 43 **C**

Match with Plays

Scrimmage where every play is a designed play (not just freestyle).

WEEK 44 **D**

Tactic: Look Off the Defender

Game with one rule: QB has to look at one receiver and throw to a different one.

WEEK 45 **A**

Long Ball

New skill: throw the deep ball. More legs, more shoulder, big follow-through.

WEEK 46 **B**

Deep Catch Drill

Long throws. Catch over the shoulder. Tough but glorious.

WEEK 47 **C**

Game with Deep Plays

Scrimmage with at least one deep ball attempt per drive.

WEEK 48 **D**

Tactic: 2 Routes, Pick Open

2 receivers run different routes. QB picks whoever is open.

WEEK 50 **B**

Position Rotation

Every 5 minutes: switch positions. Learn every job.

WEEK 52 **D**

Football Birthday

Year-end. Reflect: 3 favorite moments. Set a goal for Year 2. Celebrate.

WEEK 49 **A**

Position Play

New skill: pick a position and own it. QB, receiver, center, defender — know your job.

WEEK 51 **C**

Friends & Family Game

Get a real game going with cousins/neighbors. Real teams. Real fun.

'' The format is the frame. The content is the painting. The frame stays steady so the painting can be bold. ''

Drills get the body strong. Games get the spirit strong. Mix them in every practice. Most use one ball and an open yard — perfect for the backyard. Some need a buddy or two. Others are perfect for when Alexander joins.

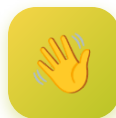


500 **CLASSIC**

The backyard football classic. One player is the QUARTERBACK and throws the ball up. Everyone else tries to catch it. Catching = 100 points. Tipping it (then catching) = 75. Catching on one bounce = 50. First to 500 points becomes the new quarterback.

Why it's perfect for the brothers: built-in regulation breaks (each throw resets the field), social and silly, predictable structure with novelty, and Alexander can be the QB while Nicolas catches.

 "Catch it. Add the points."



Two-Hand Touch

Simpler than flag football — no flags needed. Two hands touch the ball-carrier below the shoulders = tackled. Otherwise same as flag.

 "Two-hand tag."

 **Watch**



Tire Throw (Target Practice)

Hang a tire from a tree (or use a hula hoop on a stand). Stand 10 yards away. Throw the football THROUGH the tire. 10 throws, count makes.

💬 "Aim. Spiral. Through."

▶ Watch



Hot Potato Football

Stand in a circle. Pass the ball as fast as possible. Drop it = you're out. Last one wins.

💬 "Soft hands. Fast pass."

▶ Watch



Cone Routes

Set up cones for slants, outs, posts. Run each route in turn. Daddy throws to the spot where the route ends.

💬 "Sharp cuts. Look back."

▶ Watch



Flag Tag

Wear flag belts. No ball. Just chase each other and pull flags. Last one with both flags wins.

💬 "Flag, not body."

▶ Watch



Red Light, Green Light Football

Daddy says "green!" — you sprint with the ball. "Red!" — STOP. "Yellow!" — slow motion. Builds ball control under pressure.

 "Stop on red."

 Watch



Touchdown Race

Daddy and Nicolas line up at the goal line. Daddy throws the ball downfield. Whoever catches it RUNS to the opposite goal line. Defender tries to pull the flag.

 "Catch, then sprint."

 Watch



Pop Pass Rally

Cooperative game. Quick short pops back and forth, 5 yards apart. How many in a row without dropping?

 "Soft hands. Beat our record."

 Watch



Beat the Clock

60 seconds. How many "completions" (caught passes) can Daddy throw to Nicolas? Beat the score each week.

 "Fast hands."

 Watch



Pass & Spot

Each catch, you "spot" the ball where you caught it. Try to make it to a target (tree, end zone) in 5 catches.

 "Move the ball forward."

[▶ Watch](#)



Wall Spiral (Indoor)

Rainy day? Throw a small football against a wall, catch the rebound. Build the wrist snap.

 "Snap the wrist."

[▶ Watch](#)

[▶ Watch](#)

Watch fun football games in action



500 (Backyard Football)

A walk-through of the classic 500 game.

[▶ Watch](#)



Flag Football Drills

Drills for kids learning flag football.

[▶ Watch](#)

Make any drill more fun

- **Add a story.** "You're down by 4 with 10 seconds left. Throw the Hail Mary."
- **Add silly cues.** "Aim for the tree. Hit the tree, win a million dollars."
- **Add a target.** A cone, a tire, a chalk square. Aim is more fun than just throwing.
- **Add a count-out-loud.** "Hut!... Hut!... HUT!" Builds rhythm. Builds confidence.
- **Add a victory move.** Touchdown dance. Spike the ball (gently). The "first down" point.
- **Add music.** Bring a speaker. Pick the songs. Football to a beat.

A picture story about a football practice. Read it with Mom or Dad before the day. Read it again whenever you want. The pictures show what to expect. The words show what to do.

Nicolas Plays Backyard Football

A story about my lesson



PAGE 1

My name is Nicolas. I am a football player.



PAGE 2

Today is football practice. I will play with Coach.



PAGE 3

I pack my bag. Racquet. Water bottle. Snack. I am ready.



PAGE 4

We go to the backyard. I have my football and water.



PAGE 5

I see Coach. He says "Hi Nicolas!" I can say hi back, or wave, or smile.



PAGE 6

First we warm up. We jog. We stretch. My body wakes up.



PAGE 7

Then we do drills. Coach feeds me balls. I hit them.



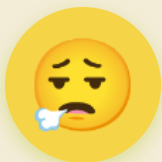
PAGE 8

Sometimes I hit it great. I feel proud.



PAGE 9

Sometimes I miss. That is OK. Even pros miss balls. Missing means I am learning.



PAGE 10

If I feel frustrated, I can take a deep breath. I can ask for a water break. That is allowed.



PAGE 11

Coach helps me. He gives me a tip. I try again.



PAGE 12

At the end, we play a fun game. I love this part.



PAGE 13

When the lesson is done, I shake Coach's hand. I say "Thank you Coach!"



PAGE 14

I tell Mom or Dad one thing I liked. One thing I learned. One thing that was hard.



PAGE 15

Football makes me strong. Football makes me focused. Football makes me happy. I am a football player.

'' Missing a pass is part of the game. Learning is part of the game. Showing up is part of the game. You belong on the field. ''

Music is part of the practice. Songs help Nicolas preview what's coming, regulate his body between blocks, and celebrate the joy of a great catch. Tap to play. Add new ones any time.

Add a Suno Song

Made a song on Suno? Paste the share link here so it lives in your playlist forever.

Song Title

e.g. My Hype Song

Suno URL

<https://suno.com/s/...>

Add to Playlist

Nicolas's Football Playlist

Tap any song to listen. Use them before practice, between blocks, or after a great game.



Make Your First Football Song

Same workflow as the tennis songs. Some ideas:

1. "Hut Hut Hut" — a rhythm song for snaps and pre-snap routines.
2. "Nicolas the Receiver" — a hype song to play before a game.
3. "Spiral Spiral" — a song about the throwing motion.
4. "The Backyard Bowl" — a song for when Nicolas and Alexander play in the yard.
5. "Pulled the Flag" — a celebration song.



How to Add a New Song

Tap the green + **Add a Suno Song** button at the top of this panel. The app will save your songs right on this iPad — they'll be there next time too.

1. Make the song on Suno together with Nicolas/Alexander.
2. Copy the share link from Suno (the URL of the song page).
3. Tap + **Add a Suno Song** above.
4. Enter the title, paste the URL, tap Save.

When to use the songs



On the way to practice

In the car. Builds anticipation.
Lets the body get into "football mode" before practice.



Warm-up block

Play a song while doing menu moves. The song's length signals when warm-up is done.



Between blocks

A 30-second song clip resets attention before moving to the next part of the lesson.



Champion moment

End every Format C lesson with a song. Pair the song with the win-feeling.



Regulation

If a moment feels hard, pause and listen to a familiar song. Then come back to the field.



Drive home

Replay the song on the way home. Pairs the music with the memory of a good game.

'' A song is a feeling you can put in your pocket. Football plus music plus rhythm plus joy — that is your game. ''